

CONTACT US



0909 711 1264



(083) 228 7570



stufaps12@ched.gov.ph



Stufaps Region XII



Commission on Higher Education (CHED) — Region
12, Regional Center, Brgy. Carpenter Hill, City of
Koronadal

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STUDENT FINANCIAL ASSISTANCE PROGRAMS (STUFAPS)

Commission on Higher Education — Region 12



CHED MERIT SCHOLARSHIP PROGRAM (CMSP)

The CHED Merit Scholarship Program (CMSP) is a competitive scholarship initiative of the Commission on Higher Education (CHED) that aims to support academically talented and deserving Filipino students. This program is intended for incoming/current first-year college students who have demonstrated exceptional academic performance and potential for excellence in higher education. Specifically, the CMSP is open to student applicants who have achieved a minimum **General Weighted Average (GWA) of 93%** or its equivalent in their Grade 12 report card.

✓ REQUIREMENTS

ELIGIBILITY

- Filipino citizen;
- Graduate of a Senior High school in the Philippines with a minimum **GWA of 93%** or its equivalent; and
- Combined annual gross income of the parents or legal guardians should not exceed **Five Hundred Thousand Pesos (PhP 500,000.00)**.

DOCUMENTARY

- Accomplished application form using Annex A;
- Copy of Birth certificate issued by National Statistics Office (NSO) or Philippine Statistics Authority (PSA);
- Certified true copy of the Form 138 [Learner's Progress Report Card or School Form 9 (SF9)], duly signed by the registrar or an authorized representative of the senior high school attended;
- The student applicants shall submit any one (1) of the following documents, whichever is applicable:
 - Latest Income Tax Return (ITR) of parents or legal guardian;
 - Certificate of Tax Exemption/Non-Filer issued by the Bureau of Internal Revenue (BIR);
 - Certified true copy of latest contract or proof of income for children of Overseas Filipino Workers (OFW) and Seafarers; or
 - Social Case Study Report issued by the City/Municipal Social Welfare and Development Office (C/MSWDO).

OTHER REQUIREMENTS, IF APPLICABLE

- Applicant's PWD ID issued by C/MSWDO or Certification of Disability issued by the Persons with Disability Affairs Office (PDAO);
- Solo Parent ID of applicant or his/her parent issued by C/MSWDO;
- Applicant's Senior Citizen ID issued by C/MSWDO;
- Certification issued by Department of Human Settlements and Urban Development (DHSUD) or C/MSWDO to Underprivileged and Homeless family;
- Social Case Study Report issued by C/MSWDO covered under Magna Carta for the Poor and/or First-Generation Students;
- Certification issued by the National Commission on Indigenous Peoples (NCIP) to the Indigenous People.
- Notarized Certificate of Guardianship, issued by the legal guardian of the student applicant, if applicable.



AGRICULTURAL COMPETITIVENESS ENHANCEMENT FUND — GRANTS-IN-AID FOR HIGHER EDUCATION PROGRAM (ACEF-GIAHEP)

The ACEF-GIAHEP aims to promote the development of agriculture and fisheries by increasing the number of graduates in higher education who are trained in the scientific habit of thought, entrepreneurial skills and technical competencies in the areas of agriculture, forestry, fisheries, and veterinary medicine education. It is open to qualified and deserving undergraduate students who will enroll or are currently enrolled in any CHED recognized higher education institution in the areas of agriculture, forestry, fisheries, veterinary medicine education and related agricultural education programs.

✓ REQUIREMENTS

QUALIFICATION

- Filipino citizen;
- Graduating high school students; High school graduates; or With earned college academic units relevant to the identified degree programs;
- Will enroll or are currently enrolled in recognized programs of PHEIs or authorized programs of SUCs/LUCs in agriculture, forestry, fisheries, veterinary medicine education and related agricultural education programs;
- Combined annual gross income of parents/guardians not to exceed **Four Hundred Thousand Pesos (PhP 400,000.00)**;
- Preferably dependent of registered farmers and/or fisherfolks in Registry System for Basic Sectors in Agriculture (RSBSA) and other registry systems;
- Must not be a beneficiary of any government funded student financial assistance program; and
- Must not be convicted of a crime involving moral turpitude.

DOCUMENTARY

- Certified true copy of Birth Certificate;
- Academic Requirement:
 - For senior high school graduates — Form 138;
 - For graduating senior high school students — duly certified true copy of grades for Grade 11 and 1st semester of Grade 12; and
 - For applicants with earned units in college — duly certified copy of grades for the latest semester/term attended;
- Proof of income — ANY of the following:
 - Latest Income Tax Return (ITR) of parent/s or guardian/s if employed;
 - Certificate of Tax Exemption from the Bureau of Internal Revenue (BIR);
 - Certificate of No Income from BIR; or
 - Certificate/Case Study Report from City/Municipal Social Welfare and Development (C/MSWD).
- Proof that the student applicant belonged to special group/s (if applicable).



ALLIED HEALTH EXPERIENTIAL ASSISTANCE FOR DESERVING STUDENTS GRANT (AHEAD)

The AHEAD Grant is offered to qualified students to provide a **one-time fixed financial assistance of Twenty-Five Thousand Pesos (PhP 25,000.00)** to help cover eligible expenses incurred in completing their Related Learning Experience (RLE) requirements and activities.

✓ REQUIREMENTS

ELIGIBILITY REQUIREMENTS

- Must be a Filipino citizen;
- Will be enrolled in any of the following CHED-recognized Bachelor's degree programs this First Semester, AY 2026–2027, offered by CHED-recognized institutions:

a. Bachelor of Science in Nursing • b. BS in Medical Technology/Medical Laboratory Science • c. BS in Midwifery • d. BS in Nutrition and Dietetics • e. BS in Occupational Therapy • f. BS in Public Health • g. BS in Physical Therapy • h. BS in Respiratory Therapy • i. BS in Radiologic Technology • j. BS in Pharmacy • k. BS in Speech Language Pathology • l. Doctor of Dental Medicine (DMD) • m. Doctor of Optometry (DO) • n. Doctor of Veterinary Medicine (DVM)

- Will be enrolled in courses with an RLE component during the applicable semester; and
- Must have a combined annual gross family income of not more than **One Million Two Hundred Thousand Pesos (PhP 1,200,000.00)**, as defined in Section II of this CMO;

DOCUMENTARY REQUIREMENTS

- Single surviving parent (death of one parent):** ITR or Certificate of Tax Exemption of the surviving parent from the BIR; PSA-issued Death Certificate of the deceased parent.
- Parent is an Overseas Filipino Worker (OFW):** ITR or Certificate of Tax Exemption of the parent in the Philippines; proof of OFW status (Overseas Employment Certificate, OFW ID, or overseas employment contract);
- Parent abandoned the family or their whereabouts are unknown:** ITR or Certificate of Tax Exemption of the present parent or legal guardian; Sworn Affidavit attesting to abandonment or absence; Barangay Certification confirming the family circumstance.
- Applicant under legal guardianship:** ITR or Certificate of Tax Exemption of the legal guardian; Court Order or DSWD Certification of Legal Guardianship; PSA Death Certificates or proof of parental incapacity, as applicable.

OTHER DOCUMENTS, IF NECESSARY

Special Equity Group — Acceptable Documentary Proof:

- Persons with Disabilities (PWDs):** Valid PWD Identification Card or a medical certificate of disability issued by the Local Government Unit — Persons with Disability Affairs Office (LGU-PDAO) or by a physician accredited by the Department of Health (DOH).
- Solo Parents or their Dependents:** Valid Solo Parent Identification Card or certification issued by the Local Government Unit (LGU), Department of Social Welfare and Development (DSWD), or the appropriate Office for Solo Parents.
- Senior Citizens:** Valid Identification Card issued by the Office of the Senior Citizens Affairs (OSCA).
- Members of Indigenous Peoples Groups:** Certificate of tribal membership issued by the recognized tribal authority or certification issued by the National Commission on Indigenous Peoples (NCIP).
- Persons Living in Poverty:** Listahanan certification, Pantawid Pamilyang Pilipino Program (4Ps) Identification Card, or certification issued by the DSWD.



THE SCHOLARSHIP PROGRAM FOR SPECIAL EQUITY GROUPS (SPSEGs)

This program is offered to support students from **Special Eligibility Groups (SEGs)** by expanding access to higher education through merit-based and empowerment-driven financial assistance, promoting student retention and successful completion of studies, and contributing to social inclusion, poverty reduction, social protection, and active participation in national development through a fair, transparent, and inclusive selection process.

✓ REQUIREMENTS

ELIGIBILITY REQUIREMENTS

Must be a member of any of the following Special Equity Groups (SEGs):

- Underprivileged and Homeless Citizens, as defined under RA No. 7279 or the Urban Development and Housing Act, as amended;
- Poor, as defined under RA No. 11291 or the Magna Carta of the Poor;
- Persons with Disabilities (PWDs), pursuant to RA No. 7277 or the Magna Carta for Persons with Disabilities, as amended;
- Solo Parents and their Children, as defined under RA No. 8972 or the Solo Parents' Welfare Act, as amended;
- Senior Citizens, as defined under RA No. 9994 or the Expanded Senior Citizens Act; and
- Indigenous Cultural Communities/Indigenous Peoples (ICCs/IPs), as defined under RA No. 8371 or the Indigenous Peoples' Rights Act.

The applicant must also:

- Filipino citizen residing in the Philippines;
- A duly certified member of any SEG, as enumerated under Article III;
- Graduate of a Senior High school (SHS) in the Philippines with a minimum general average of at least 85% or its equivalent;
- Must be admitted or enrolled in any CHED-identified priority undergraduate programs with valid GR or COPC, offered by PHEIs or SUCs duly recognized by the CHED, or LUCs with IR; and
- The applicant's individual income, if employed, or the combined annual gross income of the parent/s or legal guardian/s, in the case of children or dependents, must not exceed **Two Million Pesos (Php 2,000,000.00)**.

DOCUMENTARY REQUIREMENTS

- Accomplished Application Form (Annex A);
- Photocopy of Birth certificate issued by the National Statistics Office (NSO) or the Philippine Statistics Authority (PSA);
- Certification and/or Identification Card confirming membership in any SEG enumerated under Article III, as follows:
 - **For Underprivileged and Homeless Citizens** — Applicant's certification issued by the Local Housing Office, Urban Poor Affairs Office, the Department of Human Settlements and Urban Development (DHSUD), or the City/Municipal Social Welfare and Development Office (C/MSWDO), or proof of inclusion in the Community-Based Monitoring System (CBMS), as certified by the C/MSWDO;
 - **For Individuals covered under the Magna Carta for the Poor** — Applicant's Social Case Study Report or proof of inclusion in the CBMS, as certified by the C/MSWDO;
 - **For PWDs** — Applicant's valid PWD identification card (ID) issued by the Persons with Disability Affairs Office (PDAO) or certification issued by the C/MSWDO;
 - **For Solo Parents and their Children** — Applicant's or his/her parent's valid solo Parent ID issued by the C/MSWDO;

- **For Senior Citizens** — Applicant's Senior Citizen ID issued by the Office of the Senior Citizens Affairs (OSCA); and
- **For IPS** — Applicant's certification issued by the National Commission on Indigenous Peoples (NCIP).
- Certified true copy of Form 138 [Learner's Progress Report Card or School Form 9 (SF9)], duly signed by the registrar or an authorized representative of the SHS attended;
- Submit the appropriate and latest proof of income applicable to the academic year being applied for, as available, through any one (1) of the following documents:
 - Income Tax Return [Bureau of Internal Revenue (BIR) Form No. 1701/1701A] or Certificate of Compensation Payment/Tax Withheld (BIR Form No. 2316) indicating the annual gross income of the applicant, if employed, or of the parent/s or legal guardian/s;
 - Certificate of Tax Exemption/Non-Filer issued by the Bureau of Internal Revenue (BIR);
 - Certified true copy of contract or proof of income for children of Overseas Filipino Workers (OFW) and Seafarers; or
 - Social Case Study Report issued by the C/MSWDO.
- Notarized Certificate of Guardianship, issued by the legal/authorized guardian of the student applicant, if applicable.



SCHOLARSHIP GRANT FOR CHILDREN AND DEPENDENTS OF SUGARCANE INDUSTRY WORKERS AND SMALL SUGARCANE FARMERS (SIDA-SGP)

The SIDA-SGP is open to qualified and deserving children and dependents of sugarcane industry workers and small sugarcane farmers. This program shall cover both undergraduate and graduate students who will enroll or are currently enrolled in relevant fields of discipline in State Universities and Colleges (SUCs). This is to encourage interest in fields of discipline which are necessary for the development, sustainability and competitiveness of the Philippine sugarcane industry such as but not limited to agriculture; agricultural engineering and mechanics; chemical engineering and sugar technology; agricultural extension; chemistry; agricultural business and economics, accounting and statistics; biology, microbiology and biotechnology.

✓ REQUIREMENTS

ELIGIBILITY

1.1 Undergraduate Program

- Must be a Filipino Citizen;
- High school graduate or with earned college academic units relevant to the identified degree program;
- Must pass the entry level requirements of identified SUC;
- Duly certified by SRA as Sugarcane Industry Workers and Small Sugarcane Farmer's children and dependents; and
- Must have a combined annual gross income of parent/guardian not to exceed **Php 400,000.00**.

1.2 Graduate Program

- Must be a Filipino Citizen;
- With related undergraduate degree program and must pass the entry level requirements of identified SUC for master and doctoral degree programs;
- Duly certified by SRA as Sugarcane Industry Workers and Small Sugarcane Farmer's children and dependents; and
- Applicant and/or spouse must have a combined annual gross income of not exceed **PHP 500,000.00**.

DOCUMENTARY

Undergraduate Program

- For graduating Senior High School students — duly certified true copy of grades for grades 11 and 1st semester of Grade 12;
- For Lifelong Learners eligible for college — High School Report Card;
- For applicants with earned units in college — duly Certified Copy of Grades for the latest semester/term attended;
- For other Applicants:
 - ALS — duly certified copy of ALS Accreditation and Equivalency Test Passer Certificate;
 - PEPT — duly certified copy of PEPT Certificate of Advancing to the next level.
- Certificate of Good Moral Character from the last school attended;
- Certificate from SRA as children and dependents of sugarcane industry workers and small sugarcane farmers;
- Notice of admission from the SUC;
- Proof of Income — any one (1) of:
 - Latest Income Tax Return (ITR) of parents/guardians if employed;
 - Certificate of Tax Exemption from the Bureau of Internal Revenue (BIR);
 - Certificate of No Income from BIR;
 - Certificate of Indigence from their barangay;
 - Certificate/Case Study from Department of Social Welfare and Development (DSWD); or
 - For Children of OFW and Seafarers, a latest copy of contract or proof of income may be considered.

Graduate Program

- Diploma and Transcript of Records (TOR) of baccalaureate/master's degree or approved thesis/dissertation proposal approved and endorsed by the Technical Working Group (TWG) for grant;
- Certificate of Good Moral Character from the last school attended;
- Certification from SRA as children and dependents of Sugarcane Industry Workers and Small Sugarcane Farmers;
- Notice of Admission from the SUCs; and
- Proof of Income — any one (1) of:
 - Latest ITR;
 - Certificate of Tax Exemption from the BIR;
 - Certificate of No Income from BIR;
 - Certificate of Indigence from their barangay; or
 - Certificate/Case Study from DSWD.



SCHOLARSHIP PROGRAM FOR COCONUT FARMERS AND THEIR FAMILIES (CoScho)

The scholarship program aims to raise social equity of coconut farmers and ultimately alleviate poverty through the provision of quality education to coconut farmers and/or their dependents. It is ultimately expected to improve agricultural productivity and modernization in the coconut industry by raising the knowledge of coconut farmers and/or their dependents on scientific advances in agricultural technology and other related fields, and motivate the younger generation to be engaged in the agriculture sector.

✓ REQUIREMENTS

ELIGIBILITY

- Filipino citizen;
- Graduating high school student / high school graduate with a general weighted average grade (GWA) of 80% or its equivalent, or a college student with earned academic units relevant to the degree programs identified by PCA with a GWA of 80% the previous semester or its equivalent;
- Pass the entry level requirements of identified State Universities and Colleges (SUCs);
- Not be a recipient of any government-funded financial assistance program;
- Duly registered coconut farmer in the NCFRS or his/her dependent; and
- Must have a combined annual gross income of parents not exceeding **₱ 300,000.00**.

DOCUMENTARY

- Birth Certificate issued by the Philippine Statistics Authority;
- Academic:
 - For senior high school students — duly certified true copy of grades for Grade 11 and first semester for Grade 12;
 - For senior high school graduates — Form 138 or SF 9;
 - For ALS graduate — duly certified true copy of grades for Grade 12; and
 - For applicants with earned units or currently enrolled in college — duly Certified Copy of Grades for the latest semester/term attended;
- PCA Certification;
- Certificate of Good Moral Character from the last school attended (applicable for incoming first year college applicants or transferees);
- Notice of admission from the HEIs (for incoming first year college students or transferees);
- Proof of Income — ANY of the following:
 - Latest Income Tax Return (ITR) of applicant and/spouse/parents/guardians if employed;
 - Certificate of Tax Exemption from the Bureau of Internal Revenue (BIR);
 - Certificate of No Income from BIR;
 - Certificate of Low Income from the BIR indicating the actual amount of income; or
 - Certificate/Case Study from City/Municipal Social Welfare and Development Office (C/MSWDO).
- Original/certified true copy of certification issued by the HEIs certifying that the applicant is currently enrolled in CoScho identified priority programs and not enjoying any national government-funded scholarship program (for currently enrolled college student applicants — 2nd, 3rd and 4th year levels).

OTHER REQUIREMENTS, IF APPLICABLE

Additional five (5) points to applicants belonging to special equity group (*whichever is applicable to the applicant*):

- Original/certified true copy of the certification issued by the National Commission of Indigenous Peoples (NCIP) attesting that the student applicant belongs to indigenous group/s;
- Original/certified true copy of the certification issued by the C/MSWDO attesting that parents/guardians and siblings of the student applicant had never attended college/university;
- Certified true copy of the PWD ID issued by LGU's Person with Disability Affairs Office (PDAO) or City/Municipal Social Welfare and Development Office; or
- For Solo Parent or Son/Daughter of a Solo Parent — Certified true copy of the Solo Parent issued by the C/MSWDO.



MEDICAL SCHOLARSHIP AND RETURN SERVICE (MSRS)

The MSRS program aims to help deserving medical students pursue medical education and training in the field of health and medicine. It is accessible to qualified and deserving Filipino students willing to undertake the mandatory return service — preferably those residing in municipalities without government physicians, Geographically Isolated and Disadvantaged Areas (GIDA) or the top twenty (20%) provinces and/or municipalities (as identified by the PSA), calamity-prone and conflict areas, low-income class municipalities with poverty incidence; those belonging to ethnic or indigenous populations/communities (as certified by the LGU and the NCIP), dependents of community health volunteers, and those with combined annual family income of less than PhP 450,000.00.

✓ REQUIREMENTS

QUALIFICATION

- Must be a Filipino citizen residing in the Philippines;
- Must be a graduating student or a graduate of an appropriate undergraduate program identified as a prerequisite for a Doctor of Medicine degree, from any HEI duly recognized by the CHED, including a direct entrant to the Integrated Liberal Arts and Medicine (INTARMED) Program who satisfactorily completes the first two (2) years of the Program; provided that deserving incoming second year medical students and those in higher year levels of the Doctor of Medicine Program shall also be covered, as long as they have complied with the academic requirements and retention policies of the school in the past terms preceding their scholarship application;
- Must have passed the entrance examinations and complied with other related requirements for admission into a Doctor of Medicine degree in the SUC or PHEI where the scholar intends to enroll, as well as the other requirements of the CHED and the DOH; and
- Must obtain a National Medical Admission Test (NMAT) score mandated by the CHED and required by the SUC or PHEI where the student intends to enroll in.

DOCUMENTARY REQUIREMENTS

General

- Proof of Filipino citizenship such as any government-issued document showing proof of Filipino citizenship, including, but not limited to, certified true copy of birth certificate, PHILSYS ID;
- Certificate of Good Moral Character;
- Additional requirements for priority groups (as applicable):
 - Certificate of Residency from Barangay;
 - Certification as members of indigenous people or minority group/national commission on indigenous people (NCIP) certificate; and

- Tax exemption/Tax Declaration (from BIR) or social case study duly signed by a registered social worker where the applicant resides.

Specific

- Certification of Acceptance from the SUCs and PHEIs (i.e. have passed the admission requirements, standards and policies of chosen HEI as well as the other requirements of the CHED); and
- Affidavit of No Existing Scholarship Grant (i.e. have not availed of any other scholarship grants or with return service obligation at the time of application or at the same period).